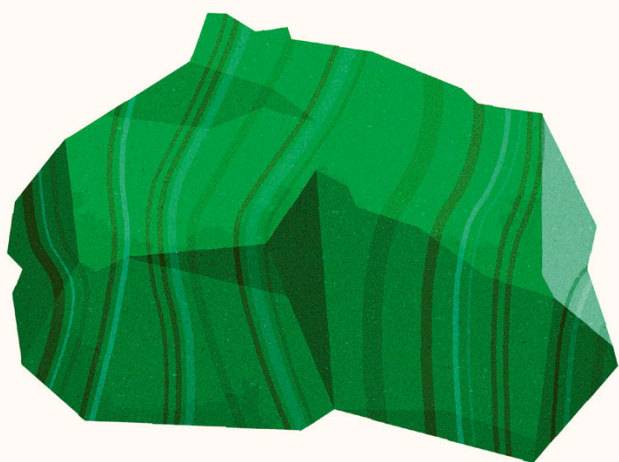


*The Ancient Egyptians smashed up  
lumps of malachite into powder to  
make green paint 5,000 years ago.*

# Malachite



Can you guess which metal is found inside malachite (mal-a-kite)? It may seem strange with its bright-green colour, but malachite is full of brown copper. Malachite often grows in layers, which gives it a stripy appearance, and it is often used as a gem.

In the 1800s, huge blocks of malachite were discovered in Russia – some pieces weighed the same as five elephants! Parts of these were used to decorate the “Malachite Room”, in the Winter Palace in St Petersburg. Today, one of the most famous malachite objects is the trophy awarded to winners of the FIFA World Cup football tournament, which has bands of malachite around its base.